

LuaT_EX for dummies

(so you can still leave)

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**The T_EX
perspective**

**The Lua
perspective**

**The hybrid
perspective**

**The
complications**

The future

This workshop

Just plain

A bit less plain

Hardly plain

The T_EX perspective

- it started out as pdfT_EX
- then got merged with Aleph
- but we left out the ugly bits of both
- it's exclusively utf-8
- it's math machinery got extended with OpenType like features

The LUA perspective

- it just a Lua engine
- it has some extra libraries on board
- you don't even have to use $\text{T}_{\text{E}}\text{X}$
- but there are hooks into the $\text{T}_{\text{E}}\text{X}$ machinery
- and we can go further by loading libraries

The hybrid perspective

- we can extend $\text{T}_\text{E}\text{X}$ using Lua
- eventually everything will be opened up
- users never have to see any of that
- they can simply use Lua for scripting and print results to $\text{T}_\text{E}\text{X}$
- but developers can go deep into the $\text{T}_\text{E}\text{X}$ internals and mess around

The complications

- normally one wants a bit of infrastructure (management)
- and maybe a special user space, hidden from core extensions
- but history has taught that users can't be controlled that way
- so we stick to just providing the mechanisms

The future

- there are a couple of generic modules (derived from ConT_EXt)
- in principle I can make more generic modules
- that's after all the idea behind the (to be) MetaT_EX variant
- but does it really make sense as one still needs substantial subsystems

This workshop

- just using Lua: it's what most users will do
- showing the hooks: it's what developers want to use
- answering questions: it's probably the most I can do

Just plain

We need to make a format, like:

```
luatex --ini plain \dump
```

and can then run files with:

```
luatex --fmt=plain somefile.tex
```

This is a another way:

A bit less plain

In order to profit from OpenType fonts:

```
mtxrun --script plain --make
```

with:

```
mtxrun --script plain somefile.tex
```

On windows you can copy `mtxrun.exe` to `plain.exe` and stick to:

Hardly plain

If you can live with a bit less plain:

```
context yourfile.tex
```